

CORNELL SCALE FOR DEPRESSION IN DEMENTIA

Screening and Assessment of Depression in Patients with Dementia

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

A. MOOD & BEHAVIOR

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
1. Anxiety (worry, fearful)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
2. Sadness (tone, tearful)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
3. Lack of Reactivity	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
4. Irritability (easily annoyed)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
5. Agitation (restlessness)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
6. Retardation (slow speech/mov)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
7. Multiple Physical Complaints	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
8. Loss of Interest / Energy	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)

B. CYCLIC & IDEATIONAL

Parameter / Criterion	Options & Points
9. Appetite Loss (eating less)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
10. Weight Loss (>2kg / 1mo)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
11. Lack of Energy	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
12. Diurnal Variation (worse AM)	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
13. Difficulty Falling Asleep	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
14. Multiple Night Awakenings	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
15. Early Morning Awakening	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
16. Suicide / Self-Harm Thoughts	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
17. Poor Self-Esteem	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
18. Pessimism / Guilt	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)
19. Mood-Congruent Delusions	☐ Absent (0) ☐ Mild / Intermittent (1) ☐ Severe (2)

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 38 points (0 to 38))

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

No Depression (0 - 7 points)

Depressive symptoms unlikely. Continue supportive dementia care.

Mild / Probable Depression (8 - 12 points)

Probable depressive disorder. Behavioral environmental optimization, reevaluate.

Definite Major Depression (≥ 13 points)

Major depression in dementia. Psychogeriatric evaluation, consider antidepressant therapy.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment